SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #51 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

"The people who disagree with me are evil."

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Where it often comes from

Constant exposure to outrage, friends who share one view, and media that profits from anger teach us to see the other side as enemies. Friendships and families fracture. We feel righteous but also anxious and angry.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you." Paul writes, "Our struggle is not against flesh and blood," and "Do not repay anyone evil for evil... If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone." "A gentle answer turns away wrath." James says, "Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger." Proverbs warns, "He who answers a matter before he hears it—this is folly and disgrace to him." We can hold convictions firmly and still treat those who differ as people made in God's image.

> *"But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you"* (Matthew 5:44).

Also see

> "For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world's darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms" (Ephesians 6:12).

> "Do not repay anyone evil for evil. Carefully consider what is right in the eyes of everybody. If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone. Do not avenge yourselves, beloved, but leave room for God's wrath. For it is written: 'Vengeance is Mine; I will repay, says the Lord.' On the contrary, 'If your enemy is hungry, feed him; if he is thirsty, give him a drink. For in so doing, you will heap burning coals on his head.' Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good" (Romans 12:17–21).

> "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger" (Proverbs 15:1).

> "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man's anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires" (James 1:19–20).

Common self-statements

- They are the problem.
- They want to destroy the country.
- Anyone who thinks that is a bad person.
- There is no good in them.
- I cannot be friends with them.
- I have to fight them.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing people as completely good or evil.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know their motives.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling angry and concluding that they are wicked.
- Fortune telling: Predicting the worst from them.

Challenging questions

- What do I actually know about the people who disagree with me?
- Do I know anyone personally with a different view, and are they evil?
- What does Jesus say about enemies?
- How is my anger affecting me?
- What are my own blind spots?
- How can I listen before I answer?

Truth summary

> People who disagree with me are made in God's image, not enemies to destroy. I can hold convictions firmly, listen well, and speak with gentleness. My struggle is not against flesh and blood.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anger
- Judgmental
- Prejudice
- Peace
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "The people who disagree with me are evil"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The people who disagree with me are evil." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I really know?
- ☐ Do I know someone personally?
- ☐ What does Jesus say?
- ☐ How is anger affecting me?
- ☐ What are my blind spots?
- ☐ How can I listen?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am called to love my enemies.
- ☐ My struggle is not against flesh and blood.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ I can be quick to listen.
- ☐ Peace is possible where I can.
- ☐ Others are made in God's image.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 5:44**
  "But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you."
- ☐ **Proverbs 15:1**
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."
- ☐ **James 1:19–20**
  "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man's anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Listen first: Each week, note one conversation where you listened before answering.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Matthew 5:44 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will love my enemies and pray for them.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Judgmental" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Check your diet. Notice how much outrage media you consume.
- ☐ Listen once. Ask someone with a different view to explain why.
- ☐ Pray for them. Pray for the person or group you resent.
- ☐ Memorize Proverbs 15:1. Use it when you feel heated.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The people who disagree with me are evil": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Listen first
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The people who disagree with me are evil.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have judged those who disagree with me. Soften my heart, teach me to listen, and help me love my enemies as You command. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.